

THE GOTHIC FOLLY

A sixty-foot cathedral of scaffolding and light, raised on the playa and open to anyone who wanders beneath its arches.

60 ft	35,900	2 builds	3 events
Spire height	Programmable LEDs	Black Rock City, Brooklyn	In 2026

Artists

Alex Noerpel & Hunter Keene, New York

Builds

Black Rock City, Burning Man 2026

Industry City, Brooklyn

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Cover photo: @plainjane

A space for all people...

The Gothic Folly recasts the emotional power of sacred architecture in scaffolding and light.

A central rose window of mesh and LEDs hangs suspended between two main towers. Four spires define the facades, draped with canopy lights that highlight the roof lines, and cascading pointed arches form the nave. By day its open frame holds the sky and casts shifting shadows across the ground. At night it becomes a beacon, lit and played live through Folly Mix.

What was once designed for doctrine becomes a space for collective devotion, directed outward toward one another instead of upward toward a single authority.

Height	60 ft to the spire tips
Envelope	Approx. 36.5 × 28.3 × 19.2 m
Frame	Scaffolding towers, four spires, cascading pointed arches
Rose window	Mesh and LEDs, suspended
Light	35,900 programmable LEDs
Control	Folly Mix over sACN or DDP



Day · @plainjane



Night · @grewithoneg_



@paulalkoby

The artists

Alex Noerpel & Hunter Keene

Two multidisciplinary artists from New York whose work spans architecture, Broadway carpentry, scenic design, graphic design, printmaking, painting, street art and fashion. The Folly is the culmination of a lifelong fascination with the emotional power of space.

hunterkeene.com · @alexnoerpel

Builds

Two builds, three events



@paulalkoby

Black Rock City, Nevada

The debut, in its full configuration. Listed in the official 2026 art program, the Folly opened at dusk on August 30 with music, ritual and light.

Event	Burning Man 2026
Dates	Aug 30 – Sep 2026
Configuration	Four towers, full nave, rose window, canopy



Industry City at dusk

Industry City, Brooklyn

The second build, reconfigured to fit between warehouse walls. Raised once, it stood through two Halloween weekends.

Events	City of Gods (House of Yes and ZERO), Vampire Ball
Dates	Oct 23 – 24 and Oct 30 – 31, 2026
Configuration	Front towers and spires, major arches, rose window

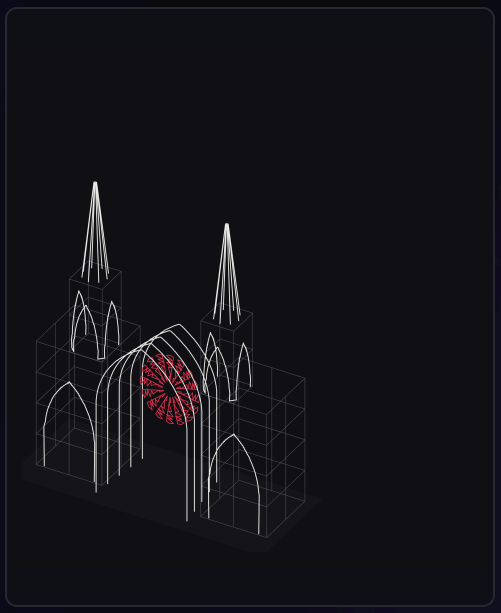
Adaptations

One structure, shaped to the site

The Folly can respond to its environment, changing its form to fit each site while keeping its presence. Folly Mix adapts every look to whichever parts are standing.



Burning Man: the full Folly



Industry City: the front of the cathedral

Press

“This 60-foot masterpiece constructed by Alex Noerpel and Hunter Keene echoed Gothic cathedrals.”

FreeYork

“A towering 60-foot Gothic Folly cathedral outline.”

e-a-a.com

“One of the large pieces on the playa this year.”

Dusted

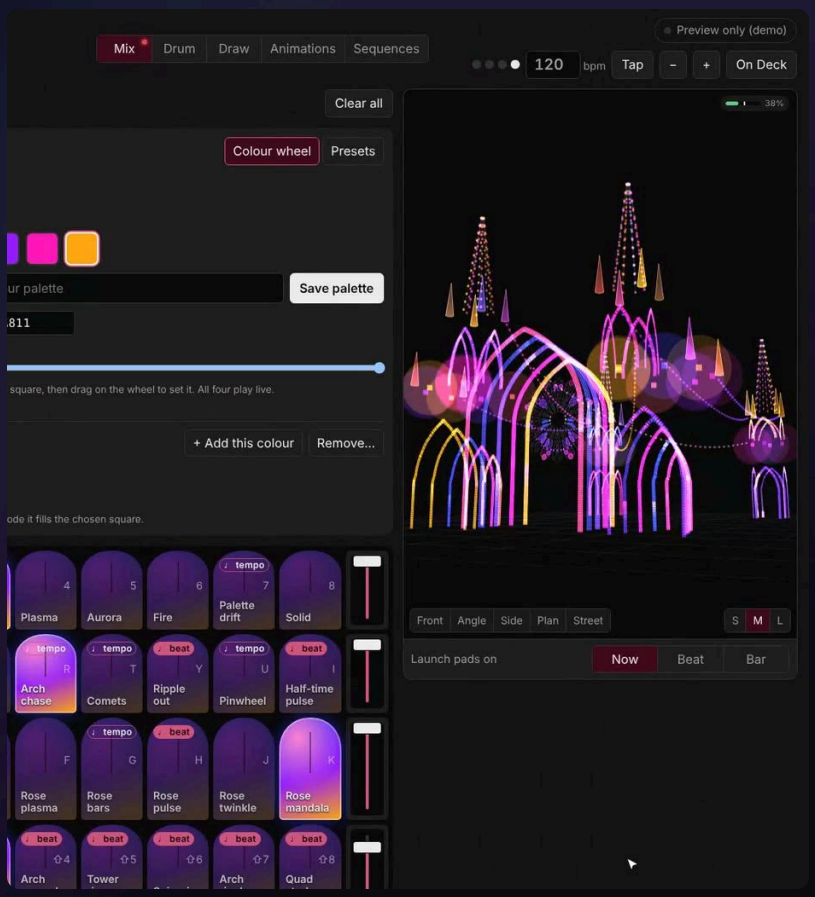
Nov 9, 2026	Penn State Stuckeman School	From Penn State to Burning Man: Alumni debut projects at desert festival
Sep 13, 2026	ArchiPanic	Burning Man 2026 explored the connection between different realms
Sep 23, 2026	FreeYork	Burning Man 2026: Towering Creations and Emotional Narratives
Sep 22, 2026	e-a-a.com	Ephemeral Desert Architecture: Burning Man’s 2026 Engineering Marvels
Oct 2026	Accuracy Third	S10 E00 · Afterburn 2026: Synecdoche Feeling (podcast)
Sep 12, 2026	Dusted	Dusted: Burning Man 2026
2026	Burning Man Project	2026 Art Listings: The Gothic Folly

Folly Mix

Play the structure like an instrument

Lighting software custom-coded for the Folly. Every arch, spire, tower and rose-window cell is individually addressable, and every effect follows one adjustable global BPM.

Pages	Mix, Drum, Draw, Animations, Sequences
Control	Phone, iPad or tablet
Output	sACN to Falcon F48V5, or DDP to FPP



A look built from four colors and four layered effects

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